PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Thursday, October 9, 2025

Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center, 501 N. Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members: Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller (Committee Chair), Virginia La Forte, and Christy Splitt
Board Members (Non-Committee): Chair Eddie Wang

Other Attendees:
Kara Bradshaw – Confidential Executive Assistant, Board Clerk
Jey Buno – Chief of Student Support Services
Dr. Kelly Charles – Senior Director of Special Education
Kristina Howard – Senior Chief of Academics
Rosanne Powell – Senior Board Manager

Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 4:33 pm by Committee Chair Rashelle Chase-Miller.

Public Comment

Time: 4:35 pm

- Jocelynn Haley Cambier – Share concerns regarding insufficient staffing at Rose City Park in Vietnamese Dual Language program and the Urged the Board to hire additional staff to ensure the success of the students and the program as a whole.
- Tri To – Provided comment in Vietnamese.
- Susan Carson with her student in the Special Education program at McDaniel: Thanked the Committee and District for focusing on Special Education and for the positive changes that she has seen. She urged the District to ensure that there are sufficient paraeducators in schools.

Overview: Special Education Services

Time: 4:42 pm

Jey Buno and Dr. Kelly Clark

Staff provided an overview of the special education department's key focuses over the past year, including the shift to a neighborhood school model, expanded inclusion practices, and efforts to strengthen instructional quality and collaboration between general and special education staff. The presentation highlighted program data and enrollment trends by diagnosis categories and race. There was discussion regarding disproportionality in student identification and common inclusion misconceptions. Staff also described engagement with educators and families, key feedback themes, and both immediate and long-term actions to improve service delivery, including stabilizing paraeducator staffing, refining caseload models, providing professional development, and increasing communication and transparency. Board members asked questions related to staffing and teacher recruitment, equity in student identification, service delivery models, student outcomes, and funding limitations.

Adjourn

Committee Chair Rashelle Chase-Miller shared details on upcoming community engagement sessions related to the proposed changes to dual enrollment at Jefferson High School. The meeting was adjourned at 6:19 pm by Committee Chair Rashelle Chase Miller.

Submitted by:
Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools